

AI-Powered Deck Product — "DeckAI"

Competitive Analysis - Use Cases - Information Architecture - PRD

Date: August 17, 2026 | Status: Draft | Version: 1.0

Target Audience: Working professionals in tech — Designers, Marketers, Engineers, Product Managers

1. COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

1.1 Gamma App — Core Superpowers

- 🔥 AI-First Generation Engine
Gamma's strongest differentiator is its deeply integrated AI generation pipeline. Users go from prompt → AI outline → full presentation with images in under 2 minutes. 6+ AI image models with multiple art styles.
- 🔥 Multi-Format Output Flexibility
Generates Presentations, Documents, Webpages, and Social assets from the same flow — a content platform, not just slides.
- 🔥 Card-Based Architecture
Scrollable card system instead of slides. Cards can be merged, reordered, added inline.
- 🔥 Deep Theming & Brand Customization
Full theme editor: primary/secondary/accent/background/text colors, font pairing, logo upload, smart layouts, custom AI image keywords.
- 🔥 Multi-Channel Distribution
Export to PDF, PPTX, Google Slides, Print. Embed, publish to web, password-protect links.
- 🔥 AI Agent + Studio Mode (Beta)
AI agent for editing, rewriting, and content enhancement inline.

1.2 Chronicle App — Core Superpowers

- 🔥 Visual-First, Story-Driven Design
"Stories, not slides." Chapter-based narrative with cinematic covers, gradients, and widget composition.
- 🔥 Widget-Based Content System
Widget palette: Heading, Paragraph, Callout, Text Card, Number Card, Icon Card, Image, Embed, Mockup, Quote, Sticky Note.
- 🔥 Storyline-First AI Generation
AI creates a storyline first → users review/accept/retry → then full presentation generates. Per-chapter layout selectors.
- 🔥 Granular Rewrite Controls
Rewrite intensity (Subtle/Creative), content type, chapter count, language. Per-widget AI rewrite with accept/reject.
- 🔥 AI Theme Generation
Generates new color themes with AI + custom color selection with live preview.
- 🔥 Chapter Navigation & Reordering
Persistent sidebar with thumbnails, drag-and-drop reordering, chapter-count breadcrumbs.

2. SYNTHESIZED SUPERPOWERS — What to Build

Taking the best from both competitors, filtered for tech professionals, designers, marketers, and engineers:

- SP-1 Intelligent Multi-Input Creation
Combine Gamma's 4 creation paths (prompt, paste, import, template) with Chronicle's storyline-first approach. Users start from ANY input and always land in a storyline review before generation.
- SP-2 Storyline Editor with Layout Intelligence
Editable title + bullets per section, layout selector with visual previews, drag-and-drop reordering, add/delete/duplicate, character counter. This is where users build confidence.
- SP-3 AI Generation with Taste Controls
Preferences: content density, visual style, image source, language, section count. Real-time progress + satisfaction survey. Bad generation = immediate churn.
- SP-4 Widget/Block-Based Editor
Block palette: Heading, Text, Card, Number, Icon, Image, Embed, Quote, Callout, Code Block. Designers want composability, Marketers want pre-formatted blocks; Engineers want structure.
- SP-5 Deep Theming + Brand Kit
Colors (5-point system), font pairing, logo placement, AI theme generation. Live preview. Table stakes for marketing and design teams.
- SP-6 Inline AI Editing
AI rewrite on any block with accept/reject. Tone adjustment, length control, translation. Triggered from context menu — native feeling.
- SP-7 Multi-Format Export & Distribution
PDF, PPTX, Google Slides. Link sharing with password. Embed. Publish as webpage. Analytics on shared links.
- SP-8 Workspace & Collaboration
Dashboard with grid/list, search, filters, folders. Real-time collaboration with roles. Team management and credits.

3. USE CASES — Prioritized

3.1 PRIMARY USE CASES (P0 — Must Have for Launch)

- UC-P0.1 Generate a Deck from a Text Prompt
Actor: Any user
Flow: Enter prompt → Configure preferences → AI generates storyline → Review/edit → Select layouts → Generate full deck → Review → Iterate
Success: Polished deck in < 3 minutes
- UC-P0.2 Generate a Deck from Pasted Content
Actor: PM, Engineer, Marketer repurposing content
Flow: Paste text/notes → Configure preferences → AI creates storyline → Review → Generate
Success: Existing content transformed without manual re-formatting
- UC-P0.3 Generate a Deck from URL/File Import
Actor: Marketer (blog), PM (PRD), Engineer (docs)
Flow: Paste URL or upload file → AI extracts content → Configure → Storyline → Generate
Success: External content auto-transformed into a deck
- UC-P0.4 Edit & Refine a Generated Deck
Actor: Any user post-generation
Flow: Navigate via sidebar → Edit blocks inline → Add/remove/reorder → Change layouts → AI rewrite specific blocks → Undo/redo
Success: Full refinement without limitations
- UC-P0.5 Apply & Customize Themes
Actor: Designer, Marketer
Flow: Browse presets → Select → Preview live → OR customize colors/fonts/logo → OR AI-generate themes
Success: On-brand deck with minimal effort
- UC-P0.6 Present a Deck
Actor: Any presenter
Flow: Click Present → Full-screen → Navigate sections → Exit
Success: Smooth, professional presentation
- UC-P0.7 Share & Export a Deck
Actor: Sales, PM, Marketer
Flow: Copy link → Set permissions → Password (opt) → OR export PDF/PPTX → OR embed → OR publish to web
Success: Deck reaches audience on any platform
- UC-P0.8 Dashboard — Manage Decks
Actor: Any returning user
Flow: View all decks → Search/filter → Open → Create new → Organize into folders
Success: Quick access to deck library
- UC-P1.1 Start from a Template
Browse gallery by category → Preview → Select → Replace placeholder content
- UC-P1.2 Start from Scratch (Blank Deck)
Empty editor → Set title → Add sections → Add blocks from palette → Build manually
- UC-P1.3 AI Rewrite & Refine Inline
Select text block → Choose action (shorten/expand/tone/translate/grammar) → Preview before/after → Accept/reject
- UC-P1.4 Collaborate in Real-Time
Multiple cursors → Concurrent editing → Comments → Version history
- UC-P1.5 Remix / Redesign Existing Deck
Select deck → Choose new style → AI regenerates visuals, preserves content
- UC-P1.6 Workspace & Team Management
Manage members → Set roles → Configure workspace branding → Billing
- UC-P1.7 Version History & Restore
View timeline → Preview any version → Restore
- UC-P1.8 Analytics on Shared Decks
View count → Time per section → Viewer list → Engagement heatmap

4. INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE — DeckAI

- DeckAI (Web App)
 - Marketing Site (Public)
 - Landing Page — Hero, product showcase, persona use cases, pricing
 - Product / About / Pricing
 - Login / Sign Up CTAs
 - Authentication
 - Sign Up (Google OAuth / Email / SSO)
 - Email Verification
 - Login
 - Onboarding (First-time, 4 steps)
 - Step 1 — Use case: Work / Personal / Education
 - Step 2 — Role: Designer / Engineer / PM / Marketer / Sales / Leadership / Other
 - Step 3 — Intent: Create decks / Transform notes / Import existing / Not sure
 - Step 4 — Workspace setup: Name + Logo
 - Get Started — Tutorial + "Create your first deck"
 - Dashboard (Home)
 - Top Bar: Workspace switcher | Search (🔍) | Notifications | Credits | Avatar
 - Left Sidebar: All Decks | Recent | Shared | Favorites | Archived | Folders | Templates
 - Content Area: + Create New | Filters | Grid/List toggle | Sort | Deck cards
 - Settings: Workspace | Members | Billing | Fonts | Brand kit | Trash
 - Creation Flow ("Create New")
 - Method Selection
 - Generate from Prompt (Recommended)
 - Paste Text / Notes
 - Import (URL / File)
 - Start from Template
 - Start from Scratch
 - Input Step (varies by method)
 - Prompt → Free-text + suggested prompts
 - Paste → Text area + content type detection
 - Import → URL / file drag-and-drop
 - Template → Gallery with categories + preview
 - Preferences Bar (persistent)
 - Section count (3-25) | Density (4 levels) | Rewrite intensity (3 levels)
 - Language | Image style
 - Storyline Review
 - Numbered sections: Title + Bullets + Layout selector
 - Layout options: Statement | Key points | Heading+media | Media+text | Bento | Data
 - Actions: Add | Delete | Duplicate | Reorder | Counter
 - CTAs: Generate Deck | Retry Storyline
 - Generation Progress
 - Steps: Storyline → Content → Imagery → Finalizing
 - Completion toast + celebration
 - Editor (Deck Workspace)
 - Top Bar: ◀ Back | Title | Breadcrumb | Theme | Share | Present | More | Avatars
 - Left Panel — Section Navigator
 - Thumbnail list | Drag-and-drop | + Add section | Section options
 - Canvas
 - Cover Section: Title | Subtitle | Author | Cover image | Cover type toggle
 - Content Sections: Block-based composition | Between-section controls
 - Block Types (+ Insert palette)
 - Text: Heading (S/M/L) | Paragraph | Callout | Quote
 - Cards: Text | Number | Icon | Stat
 - Media: Image | Embed | Video | Mockup
 - Data: Chart | Table | Code Block
 - Utility: Sticky note | Divider | Spacer
 - Block Editing
 - Inline toolbar: Font | Bold/Italic/etc | Color | Alignment | Links
 - Background picker: Gradients | Solids | Image | Blur
 - Icon/Emoji picker
 - AI Actions: Rewrite | Improve | Translate | Grammar | Accept/Reject
 - Bottom Toolbar: + Insert | AI Remix | Media | Layout | More
 - Theme Panel (right sidebar)
 - Presets | AI-generated | Custom editor
 - Colors: Primary | Secondary | Accent | Background | Text
 - Fonts: Heading + Body families
 - Logo: Upload + placement
 - Live preview
 - Presentation Mode
 - Full-screen | Navigation | Presenter notes | Timer
 - Sharing & Distribution
 - Collaborate: Invite | Roles | Workspace sharing | Link
 - Share: Link access | Password | Expiration
 - Export: PDF | PPTX | Google Slides | Print
 - Publish: Web page | Embed code
 - Analytics: Views | Viewers | Time per section | Engagement
 - Account & Settings
 - Profile | Workspace | Members | Billing | Notifications | Integrations
 - Credit System & Plans
 - Free — Limited generations, basic export
 - Pro — Unlimited, all exports, brand kit, analytics
 - Team — Collaboration, workspace, admin controls

5. PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS — DETAILED

5.1 Product Vision

DeckAI transforms how working professionals create presentations. By combining AI-powered generation with a block-based editor and deep theming, we eliminate the blank-slide problem.

Vision: "From idea to polished deck in under 3 minutes — for every professional who presents."

5.2 Target Personas

- Persona 1 — The PM ("Priya")
Needs: Weekly status, quarterly reviews, PRD → deck. Pain: 2+ hours formatting. Trigger: "Paste my PRD and make a deck."
- Persona 2 — The Marketer ("Marcus")
Needs: Campaign recaps, pitch decks, social. Pain: Off-brand without designer help. Trigger: "Generate a pitch deck matching our brand."
- Persona 3 — The Designer ("Dana")
Needs: Design reviews, case studies, proposals. Pain: Slides look bad, Figma takes too long. Trigger: "Beautiful blocks I can compose."
- Persona 4 — The Engineer ("El")
Needs: Tech talks, arch docs, retros. Pain: Hates slides, always last minute. Trigger: "Turn my notes into a deck in 60 seconds."
- Persona 5 — The Sales Lead ("Sam")
Needs: Client pitches, demos, ROI decks. Pain: No analytics. Trigger: "Tell me when the prospect opens it."

5.3 Key Metrics

- North Star: Decks created per user per month
- Activation: % new users generating first deck in first session
- Retention: % users returning within 7 days
- Quality: Post-generation satisfaction (1-5)
- Time-to-value: Median time from Create New → completed deck
- Distribution: % decks shared/exported/published
- Collaboration: % decks with 2+ editors

5.4 Functional Requirements

- FEATURE AREA 1: AI GENERATION ENGINE
 - FR-1.1 Accept free-text prompts up to 5,000 chars
 - FR-1.2 Accept pasted text up to 50,000 chars
 - FR-1.3 Import from URLs (web pages, articles)
 - FR-1.4 Import from files (PDF, DOCX, MD, TXT, PPTX)
 - FR-1.5 Generate structured storyline before full deck
 - FR-1.6 Storyline editable: titles, bullets, ordering, add/delete
 - FR-1.7 Per-section layout selector with visual previews
 - FR-1.8 Configurable: section count (3-25), density (4 levels), rewrite (3 levels), language, image style
 - FR-1.9 Real-time generation progress with step indicators
 - FR-1.10 Complete generation in < 90 seconds
 - FR-1.11 Post-generation satisfaction survey
 - FR-1.12 Retry option for storyline and full regeneration
- FEATURE AREA 2: BLOCK-BASED EDITOR
 - FR-2.1 Block types: Heading (3 sizes), Paragraph, Callout, Quote, Text/Number/Icon/Stat Card, Image, Embed, Video, Mockup, Code Block, Table, Sticky Note, Divider, Spacer
 - FR-2.2 Insert via + button, slash command, or drag
 - FR-2.3 Drag-and-drop reorder within and across sections
 - FR-2.4 Inline formatting: bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, color, links
 - FR-2.5 Block backgrounds: solid, gradient, image, blur
 - FR-2.6 Searchable icon and emoji library
 - FR-2.7 Undo/redo with full history
 - FR-2.8 Section navigator with thumbnails + drag reorder
 - FR-2.9 Between-section controls: add, AI suggest, layout change
- FEATURE AREA 3: AI EDITING
 - FR-3.1 AI rewrite on any text block
 - FR-3.2 Options: shorten, expand, change tone, translate
 - FR-3.3 Before/after comparison with accept/reject
 - FR-3.4 Improve writing: grammar, clarity, conciseness
 - FR-3.5 AI Remix: regenerate section visuals, preserve content
 - FR-3.6 Triggerable from context menu, shortcut, or toolbar
- FEATURE AREA 4: THEMING & BRAND KIT
 - FR-4.1 10+ preset themes
 - FR-4.2 Custom: primary, secondary, accent, background, text colors
 - FR-4.3 Heading + body font families with live preview
 - FR-4.4 Logo upload with placement options
 - FR-4.5 AI theme generation
 - FR-4.6 Save and reuse custom themes
 - FR-4.7 Real-time preview on every change
 - FR-4.8 Workspace-level default brand kit
- FEATURE AREA 5: SHARING & DISTRIBUTION
 - FR-5.1 Link sharing with permissions (view/edit/comment)
 - FR-5.2 Password protection
 - FR-5.3 Export: PDF, PPTX, Google Slides
 - FR-5.4 Publish as hosted web page
 - FR-5.5 Embed codes
 - FR-5.6 Analytics: views, viewers, time per section
 - FR-5.7 Invite by email with roles
- FEATURE AREA 6: PRESENTATION MODE
 - FR-6.1 Full-screen, distraction-free
 - FR-6.2 Keyboard, click, swipe, section jump navigation
 - FR-6.3 Presenter notes
 - FR-6.4 Timer
 - FR-6.5 Smooth transitions
- FEATURE AREA 7: DASHBOARD & WORKSPACE
 - FR-7.1 Grid/list view
 - FR-7.2 Search, filter, sort
 - FR-7.3 Folder organization
 - FR-7.4 Thumbnails, titles, creators, timestamps
 - FR-7.5 Workspace settings, members, billing
 - FR-7.6 Trash with restore
 - FR-7.7 Prominent create CTA
- FEATURE AREA 8: ONBOARDING
 - FR-8.1 Google OAuth, email, SSO
 - FR-8.2 Onboarding survey (3-4 steps, < 60s)
 - FR-8.3 Workspace creation
 - FR-8.4 Tutorial + guided first creation
 - FR-8.5 AI generation as default first-run action

5.5 Non-Functional Requirements

- NFR-1 Generation: < 90s for 10 sections
- NFR-2 Editor: < 100ms for block operations
- NFR-3 10+ concurrent editors per deck
- NFR-4 99.9% uptime
- NFR-5 SOC 2 Type II compliance
- NFR-6 WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility
- NFR-7 < 5% visual deviation in exports
- NFR-8 Responsive viewer (editor desktop-first)
- NFR-9 10+ languages supported

6. RELEASE PHASING

- PHASE 1 — MVP (Month 1-3)
 - Core AI generation (prompt + paste + import → storyline → deck)
 - Block-based editor with essential blocks
 - Preset themes (10+) with basic customization
 - Section navigator with reorder
 - Present mode (full-screen)
 - Basic sharing (link + PDF export)
 - Dashboard (grid view, search)
 - Onboarding (sign-up, survey, first creation)
- PHASE 2 — Growth (Month 4-6)
 - AI inline editing (rewrite, improve, translate)
 - Full brand kit (custom colors, fonts, logo)
 - AI theme generation
 - Template gallery
 - PPTX + Google Slides export
 - Real-time collaboration
 - Folder organization
 - Version history
- PHASE 3 — Scale (Month 7-9)
 - Shared link analytics
 - Workspace & team management
 - AI Remix (redesign) sections
 - Embed & publish to web
 - Password-protected sharing
 - SSO / enterprise auth
 - Code block + table widgets
- PHASE 4 — Moat (Month 10-12)
 - AI Agent (autonomous deck assistant)
 - Presentation recording
 - Audience Q&A / reactions (live)
 - API & integrations (Slack, Notion, Linear)
 - Custom widget SDK
 - Advanced analytics (engagement heatmaps)

7. COMPETITIVE POSITIONING

- What we take from Gamma:
 - Multi-format thinking (presentation as one output of many)
 - Deep AI generation preferences (image model, art style, keywords)
 - Multi-channel export (PDF, PPTX, Slides, web, embed)
 - Credit-based monetization
 - Card/block-based architecture over traditional slides
- What we take from Chronicle:
 - Storyline-first generation (outline → review → generate)
 - Widget-based composition (structured blocks, not blank slides)
 - Granular rewrite controls (subtle vs. creative, per-block)
 - Chapter navigation with thumbnails
 - Visual-first design quality
 - AI theme generation

- Where DeckAI differentiates:
 - Persona-aware AI — Tailor output to role (PM = data-heavy, Designer = visual-heavy)
 - Import intelligence — Better URL/file parsing with content-type detection
 - Shared deck analytics — Built-in engagement tracking for sales/marketing
 - Brand kit as workspace infrastructure — Team-level theming across all decks
 - Code blocks & technical content — First-class support for engineering personas
 - Faster generation — Target < 60 seconds through parallel processing